

Faisal Alhatimi

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SUMMARY

MSc in Cybersecurity (BSc in Computer Science). Strong foundations in data structures, algorithms, networking, and security. QA experience testing banking services, resulted in practical exposure to application and infrastructure security.

EDUCATION

Newcastle University - MSc Cybersecurity

Master of Science in Cybersecurity

Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

Sep 2025 – Sep 2026 (expected)

Newcastle University - BSc Computer Science

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (Software Engineering)

Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

Sep 2021 – Sep 2024

CERTIFICATIONS

eLearnSecurity Certified Professional Penetration Tester (eCPPTv3)

Network penetration testing, web application testing, and post-exploitation skills

Issued Mar 2026

eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester (eJPTv2)

Practical penetration testing skills and network security fundamentals

Issued Feb 2026

CompTIA Security+

Core IT security concepts, risk management, and threat mitigation

Issued May 2025

EXPERIENCE

Software Test Engineer

Bank Albilad

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Mar 2025 – Aug 2025

- Designed and executed 500+ test scenarios across SIT and UAT environments, closing 46 test cycles.
- Identified and tracked 34 defects, collaborating with developers and stakeholders to resolve issues before release.
- Delivered 11 production features across core banking (T24), digital channels, Oracle ERP, and ServiceNow, including 4 large-scale features, ensuring stability and compliance with requirements
- Performed gray-box and black-box testing, and analysed backend application logs to trace and verify user actions.

PROJECTS

CTF & Security Lab | VMware Fusion, Kali Linux, OpenVPN, Hack the Box

Feb 2026 – Present

- Built a dedicated penetration testing lab using Kali Linux for offensive security training and tool development.
- Configured secure OpenVPN connections to access remote CTF and training environments.
- Completed multiple Hack The Box machines and challenges.
- Documented attacks, tools, and remediation recommendations to reinforce defensive security knowledge.

Hit Box Replica | Raspberry Pi, CAD, Python, PyCryptodome

April 2024 – Oct 2024

- Created a custom PS4-compatible arcade controller using Raspberry Pi and 3D-printed components.
- Researched legacy controller communication protocols and integrated Python-based logic for handling authentication data using PyCryptodome.
- Combined open-source input handling with hardware and software integration to replicate a controller's functionality.

PROGRAMMING & SECURITY TOOLS

Security Tools: Nmap, Wireshark, Hydra, Metasploit, Burp Suite

Programming Languages: Python, Bash, SQL

Frameworks & Libraries: Flask, PyCryptodome, FastAPI

Development Tools & Operating Systems: Linux, macOS, Git, Docker, Kubernetes, Tmux, Homebrew

Documentation & Markup: LaTeX, Markdown

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Concepts: Threat Modelling, Access Control, Identity and Access Management, Network Security

Professional Skills: Technical Documentation, Security Reporting

Languages: Native Arabic, Full Professional English